Cathedral Impulse: Towards a sonic art

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Abstract

This talk is a review of the processes and ideas that led to the development of the installation work entitled *Cathedral Impulse (work in progress)*. *Cathedral Impulse* is an experimental sound art installation. In this post-art era, sonic arts practice must face the challenge of re-establishing its criteria for evaluation. This may involve a reappraisal of the balance between aesthetic and intellectual conceptions of its existence. Equally, an assessment of the relations between visual and audible content in image making processes may be significant. Acoustic communication is a well understood field within the commercial media, and sound art cannot be viewed in isolation from its broader cultural context. Is it valid to continue to produce *experimental* work? Can sonic arts practice demonstrate the characteristics of a mature art form both in terms of its practice and its criticism? The installation *Cathedral Impulse* will be examined in terms of its dynamic spatialisation, its texture and spectro-morphological properties.

Biography

Ian Stevenson is a sound artist, designer and engineer. His work has appeared in theatres, broadcast media, and public spaces in Europe and Australia. He currently lives in Sydney.